

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 487

By Clemmons

A RESOLUTION to welcome Tennessean Captain Barry "Butch" Wilmore back to Earth after completing his mission aboard the International Space Station.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing an astronaut who served the disciplines of aeronautics and space flight with distinction and demonstrated his devotion to his country and his mission during his more than nine-month stay aboard the International Space Station (ISS); and

WHEREAS, after nearly 300 days in orbit, Captain Barry "Butch" Wilmore and his colleague, Captain Sunita "Suni" Williams, returned to Earth on March 18, 2025; and

WHEREAS, departing from Earth as a member of the Boeing's Starliner's first crewed mission, Captain Wilmore arrived at the ISS in June 2024 for a scheduled short stay as part of its test flight; however, technical issues prevented him and Captain Williams from returning home on the spaceship; and

WHEREAS, NASA decided to keep Captain Wilmore at the ISS for a few extra months to maintain staffing levels, later launching the SpaceX Crew-9 mission with only two astronauts, instead of the usual four, to provide Captain Wilmore and his colleague with a ride back home; and

WHEREAS, the average person would probably not relish spending more than nine months in space, but Captain Wilmore enjoyed his extra time in the cosmos, modestly referring to his extended stay as "just part of the job"; and

WHEREAS, in the early morning of March 18, 2025, Captain Wilmore and Captain Williams boarded the SpaceX Dragon at the ISS to return to Earth; after a seventeen-hour voyage, the Dragon made a water landing off the Florida coast that evening; and

WHEREAS, a proud Tennessean, Captain Barry "Butch" Wilmore hails from Mt. Juliet and has earned degrees from Tennessee Technological University and the University of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, selected as an astronaut by NASA in July 2000, Butch Wilmore is a retired U.S. Navy captain and a veteran of two spaceflights; he has accumulated more than 8,000 flight hours and 663 carrier landings; and

WHEREAS, Captain Wilmore is to be greatly commended for his dedication to duty in the face of adversity; this brave astronaut served an extended stay in space without complaint or compunction, and he is worthy of our approbation upon his return home; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we welcome Tennessean Captain Barry "Butch" Wilmore back to Earth after completing an extended nine-month mission aboard the International Space Station, thank him for his ongoing commitment to space exploration, and wish him all the best in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.